TransektCount 5.1.7

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1. Introduction

TransektCount (**Fig. 1**) is designed to assist transect counters in transect surveys in accordance with butterfly monitoring programs in Europe.



Fig. 1: Starting page

It can be used to record individuals per transect section on a species-specific basis and separated by gender and metamorphic stages according to the European Butterfly Monitoring Scheme method. Transect sections must be selected manually but can optionally be indicated automatically via GPS (see **5 GPS Usage**). TransektCount offers prepared result outputs and substitutes your field book and pencil, and if applicable a camera for documentary pictures.

Database files will be created individually for transect sections and expected butterfly species. For this purpose, a comprehensive, illustrated list of species is included. The internal database is survey-related, i.e. a new database instance is used for each survey.

The recorded data (metadata, counts and annotations) is prepared as a report table for an easy manual transfer into a butterfly monitoring system, e.g. at **https://web.app.ufz.de/tagfalter-monitoring**. It can be read directly on the smart-phone or exported as an MS Excel spreadsheet and transferred to a PC, where it can be viewed or processed more easily.

The app is published with source code and documentation as open source on **https://github.com/wistein/TransektCount**. It does not require an internet connection, contains no tracking or advertising features, and does not use Google Play services, but demands for the following permits which are needed for the app's serviceability:

- **All files access** which is needed for importing databases, species lists and track files and exporting databases, species lists and the counting results as .db, .csv or .xlsx files (exclusively in the “Documents/ TransektCount” folder and, if applicable, in “Documents/TourCount,” if TourCount is installed),
- optionally **Wakelock** to hinder the app from being switched off by the system when inactive, but get dimmed and get an insensitive screen when pocketed or held near the body and
- optionally exact **GPS location tracking** to detect sections and signal a section transition.

2. Setting Up

For installation hints refer to **chapter 6**.

When starting the app for the first time, permission for saving data must be granted. TransektCount reads from and writes exclusively to the public directory Documents/TransektCount, which is created when the app is launched for the first time (and to Documents/TourCount if the companion app TourCount is installed, see paragraph **7.4**). This data directory is not deleted when TransektCount is uninstalled; the data stored there is retained.

Later, if you have a transect track file and want GPS-controlled section detection, the permission for location recognition must be given. For more reliable location tracking on longer transects, you may optionally activate "**Allow all the time**" in the System Settings. This prevents Android from terminating the location tracking service during longer breaks in app usage.

Before initial use you should adapt the app settings to your liking (see **chapter 4**).

Initially ignore the item "**Indicate transect sections by GPS**", as certain preconditions have to be met before (see **5. GPS Usage**).

Then adapt the preliminary species list of the 1st transect section to the expected species in your transect with the species list editing functions (Add, Remove or Edit).

For this click on the Starting page "**Counting**" and then on "**SECT 01**" (**Fig. 2**). On the counting page of section 1 (**Fig. 3**), use the editing icons in the app bar of the counting page:

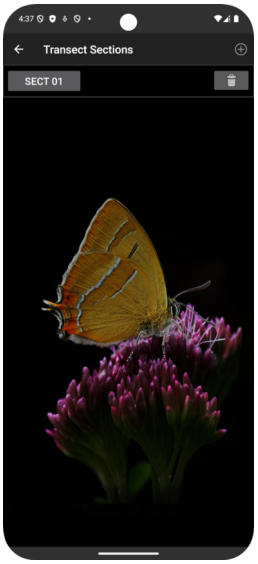


Fig. 2: "Transect Sections"

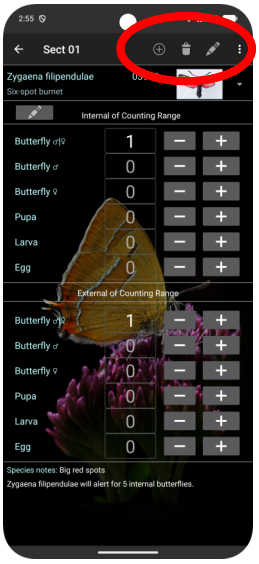


Fig. 3: Counting page menu

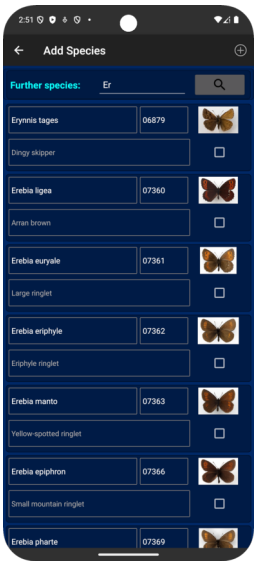


Fig. 4: "Add Species" page

- ⊕ (**Add Species**) to the counting list from the integrated large list of European species,
- 🗑 (**Remove Species**) from the counting list or
- ✎ (**Edit Terms**) of current section or species of the counting list.

All 3 editing pages offer a **preselection** to ease the selection of a distinguished species. Enter 2 or more letters of the scientific species name and then click the 🔍-button to limit the shown list. You may enter more letters and click the 🔍-button again to further reduce the selection list.

On the blue **"Add Species"** page (**Fig. 4**) tag the still needed species from the scroll-down list. Changes take effect by the ⊕-**button** in the head line. (The added species then disappear from the selection list).

At the end of the scroll-down list, a placeholder for an indeterminate species (NN) can be adopted and edited later after determination, if necessary.

On the red **"Remove Species**" page select species to remove on the scroll-down list and tip on the 🗑-button.

On the green **"Edit Terms**" page you may edit the current section name and the terms of each species. (Scientific and local species names, codes generally five digits with leading zeros, as you can see in the following species list table excerpt).

The codes will be used as an option to sort the list and as a reference to show corresponding butterfly icons. The codes derive from the numbering scheme of Karsholt/Razowski, as used e.g. in the German Lepiforum (**https://lepiforum.org/**).

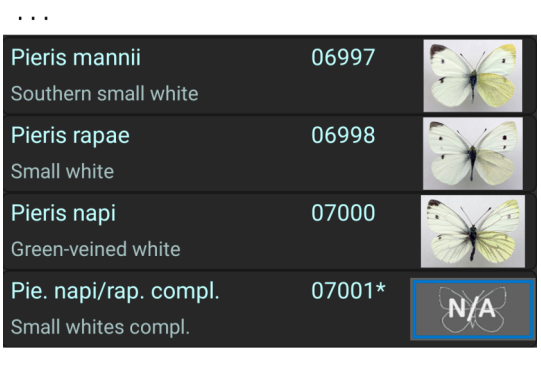


Fig. 5: Part of the species list

The *-sign attached to code 07001 in **Fig. 5** indicates a complex of species that are difficult to distinguish. For sorting purposes, the largest code within such species complexes should be used for the group.

Caution:
A wrong code will show a “N/A” or a wrong picture. If necessary, see the “**List of Coded Butterflies for TourCount and TransektCount.pdf**” featuring local names in 5 European languages on https://github.com/wistein/TransektCount/tree/master/docs.

Changes are applied using the corresponding ⊕, 🗑 or 🖫 function buttons. Changes to the species always affect all existing section lists.

Alternatively, a more comprehensive or specialized **sample species list** with local species names in either German, English, French, Italian, or Spanish can be downloaded from **https://github.com/wistein/TransektCount/tree/master/docs**, copied to the app’s data directory “**Documents/TransektCount**”, imported from there, and then customized. (The data directory is created when the app is launched for the first time. It is not deleted when TransektCount is uninstalled; the data stored there is retained.)

Once this list is complete, you can add copies for all remaining transect sections by the ⊕**-button** on top of the section list, and name each section appropriately, if possible in the order you will walk the transect, e.g.: Sect 02, Sect 03,… (s. **Fig. 2**, previous page).

In the next step, you should enter the permanent metadata like transect-No. or inspectors name. Click on “**Edit Metadata**” and save the input by clicking the save icon.

When you have created the section lists for all your transect sections and entered the general metadata, the database is ready for export as a "Basic Database". To do this, use the function "**Export as Basic DB**" in the main menu of the starting page.

By that you have a copy of the prepared empty database saved as "Basic Database" (**transektcount0_dl_Tr-No.db**) with ‘**dl**’ as data language and ‘**Tr-No**’ as transect No. within the app’s data directory “**Documents/TransektCount”**.

Note: The file names of the Basic DBs must always start with the string “**transektcount0**“ (“**transectcount**" with a trailing "**0**").

Exporting as Basic DB ignores all counts, notes and inspection-related metadata. The Basic DB serves as a template for future inspections. To prepare a future monitoring inspection you will only need to enter the inspection-specific metadata (date, start time, temperature, wind and clouds).

The Basic DB can be changed, supplemented and exported anytime. Changes of species always affect all sections to maintain consistency. However, the section name is only changed for the current section.

The naming convention for files exported by TransektCount are:

- Basic-DB: **transektcount0_dl_Tr-No.db**
- Current DB: **transektcount_dl_Tr-No_StartDate.db**
- Results: **Transect_dl_Tr-No_StartDate_osc.xlsx** or **.csv**
- Species list: **species_dl_Tr-No_CurrentDate.csv**
- Track: **transektcount_xxx.gpx**

With

- **blue**: fixed string parts,
- **dl**: data language of the local species names (“de”, “en”, “fr”, “it”, “es”),
- **Tr-No**: transect No. (formatted for file name compatibility),
- **StartDate**: Date of the inspection start (“**YYYYMMDD-hhmm**“), or if not specified, the current save date,
- **osc**: output sorting code (**n** names, **c** codes, **sn** section and names, **sc** section and codes),
- **CurrentDate**: Current save date (“**YYYYMMDD-hhmm**“) and
- **xxx**: Track name (e.g. transect No., but compatible with the filename convention)

3. Usage

Start with “**Edit Metadata**”. Fill in the relevant metadata for the specific transect inspection. You may enter the current date and time by clicking the related field or enter any date and time by long pressing the related field. To suppress unreal values for temperature, wind or clouds, plausibility checks are done when saving and refuse saving until suitable values are entered. The percentage value entered for cloud cover is rounded to the nearest ten when saved. Finish with the 🖬-button.

Then use “**Counting**”. The transect sections list appears (**Fig. 6**). If using GPS the name of the recognized section is marked blue. Select the relevant transect section.

The counting page for the first species in the sorted section list appears (**Fig. 7**). After clicking the butterfly icon select the respective species from the scroll list (**Fig. 8**).

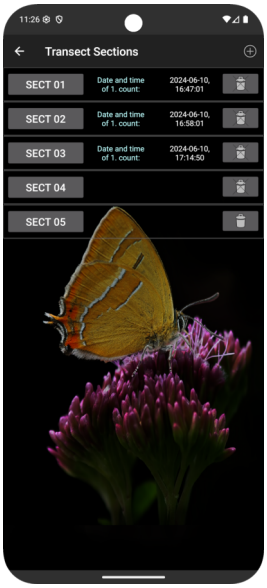


Fig. 6: “Transect Sections”

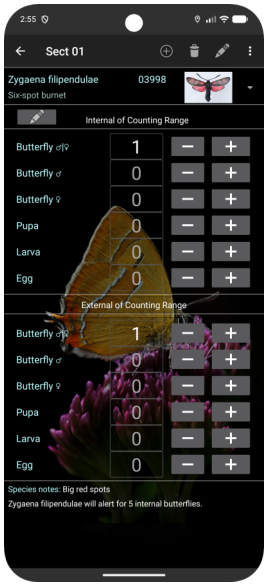


Fig. 7: Counting page

As counting of butterflies ought to be distinguished between those within the standardized, imaginary counting range (a cubus with edges of 5 m length in front of you) and those that are sighted outside the counting range, you have 2 separate sets of counters (Internal and External of the Counting Range).

To count just select the species in the scroll list, and click the appropriate (**+**)-**button** of the corresponding category (♂|♀, ♂, ♀, pupa, larva or egg).
The (**-**)-buttons allow for corrections.

Each count is stored immediately. While storing the first count in a section the current date and time will be stored for the section either.
The date will then be shown in the list of sections and indicates a successful inspection of that section. The time can be helpful later when assigning document photos.

The 🖉**-button** underneath the species name row of the counting page opens the section specific **species editing page** (**Fig. 9**) that lets you set the species’ counters to any value (e.g. for estimated mass occurrences) and add a note for the species in that section. The **“Species Notes”** field lets you enter notes or select a common species note from a pop-up list with a single click.

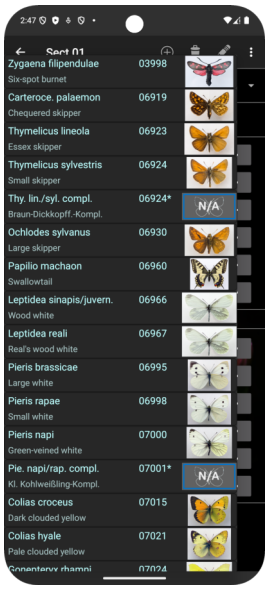


Fig. 8: Scroll-list to select species

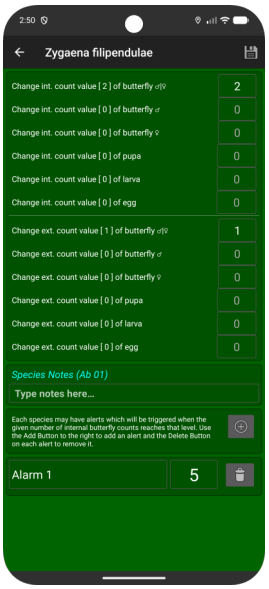


Fig. 9: Page “Edit species”

This note (e.g.: “Photo”) will be shown on the counting page in an extra line beneath the counting fields and is inserted into the results table.

If you enter a “**0**” in the species note, the species will also be listed in the results later, despite a count of 0.

To move back one page you generally can use the ⬅-button. To make sure to save changed content you should go back by tipping the respective ⊕, 🗑 or 🖬 **button**.

Before closing TransektCount after an inspection, you should **complete the metadata** with the ending values for time, temperature, wind and clouds. Then, use an “**Export Results**” option in the start page menu to save the current counts as an **.xlsx** (MS Excel) or as a **.csv** (comma separated values text) table file. The files will be named with data language, transect No., inspection start date/time and output sort code and saved as **transect_dl_Tr-No_StartDate_osc.xlsx** or **.csv** in the directory **Documents/TransektCount**. Without a given start time the current date and time is used.

When **using GPS**, a brief message indicating the distance to the transect is displayed after the app is launched and after the first GPS fix. When a transect section is reached, the app notifies the user of the current transect segment with an audio alert and a message. The app provides the same notification each time there is a change of transect sections.

The section must still be selected manually, but GPS detection supports timely switching to the current transect section, so that accidental incorrect section assignment during counting occurs less frequently.

On the “**Transect Sections**” page, the name of the newly recognized section is marked in blue after GPS recognition.

Finally, there is the “**Counting Results**” page (**Fig. 10** and **11**) showing your results sorted either by species or sections according to the selected Output sort option. Here, in a scroll view you see beneath the metadata of the inspection the totals per category and all the species which got counts.

Depending on the selected output sorting option, the included list of individuals can be sorted and displayed either by species name, species code, section and name, or by section and code.

You can enter this page from the Starting page with the "**Show Results**" button or the 👁**-icon** in the app bar.

When you have large lists or have collected big amounts of data the app may delay the start of pages, especially the results page, as this needs heavy calculations. This will be indicated by a short popup message “View gets calculated...”.

If the system message “**TransektCount not responding**” appears, please reply with “**Wait**”.

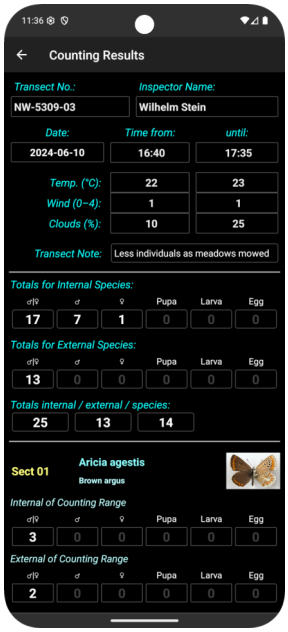


Fig. 10: Results page (head)

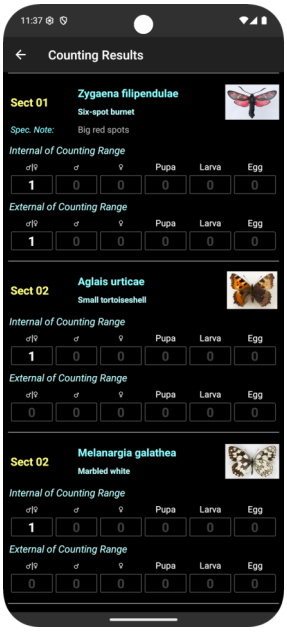


Fig. 11: Results page (cont.)

4. Further Functions

The app menu on the starting page (**Fig. 12**) has Settings, Reset, Import, Export, Info and Help functions.

In "**Settings**" (**Fig. 1**3) you may adapt the look an feel in some aspects to your wishes, e.g. sorting order of lists and data export, left-/right-hand counting page or sounds and haptic button feedback. Here you can also optionally activate the GPS function for automatic indication of the current transect section, provided a prepared GPX track file with tracks or track segments of all transect sections has been imported. For detailed information see "**5. GPS Usage**".

To prepare for a new inspection, the inspection-specific metadata and all counting data can be deleted using "**Reset Data**". All other transect-specific data remains untouched.
Alternatively you may import the Basic DB, another transektcount-DB or a species list.

Android-specifically, TransektCount stores the data in an internal SQLite DB within a storage area that is not accessible by the user. Therefore, it is necessary to import/export data to/from files in a user accessible storage area.

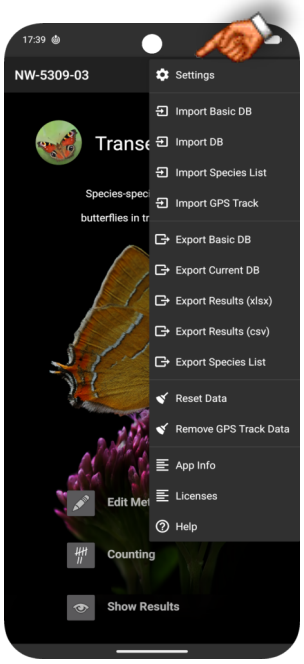


Fig. 12: System Menu

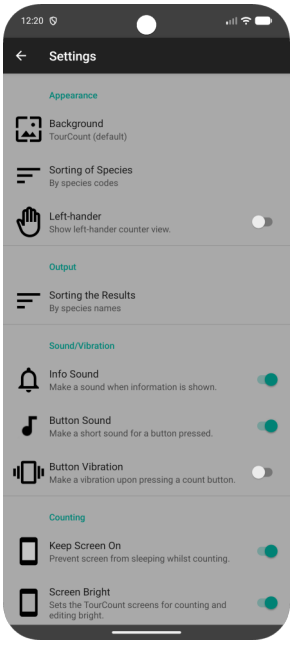


Fig. 13:Settings page (excerpt)

Starting with app **version 5.0.6**, DB files are exported with a field for identifying the data language for local species names (German, English, French, Italian, and Spanish). For imported DB files created prior to this update, the correct data language should be selected via "Settings" to ensure proper processing.

The "**Import Basic DB**" function lets you select and import a Basic DB file that was exported as a template for a certain transect. Its name begins with **"transektcount0"**.

Note: The file name of a Basic DB must always begin with "**transektcount0**" (e.g. "transektcount0_en_transect-No.db"), otherwise the database cannot be imported.

By "**Export Basic DB**" you may export the current internal DB without any inspection-specific data into a Basic DB file **transektcount0_dl_Tr-No.db** with **Tr-No** being the transect No. to **Documents/TransektCount**. This is reasonable if permanent changes have been made to the transect structure or if new species have been removed or added (see "**2. Setting Up**").

With "**Import DB**" an exported or appropriately named TransektCount DB containing count data can be selected and read into TransektCount.

Note: The file name of a TransektCount-DB with counting data must always begin with "**transektcount_**" (e.g. "transektcount_en_transect-No_date.db"), otherwise the database cannot be imported.

"**Export Current DB**" writes a copy of the DB with all currently contained data to the file **transektcount_dl_Tr-No_StartDate.db** into the directory **Documents/TransekCount**. If available in the metadata, the transect name and the date and time the survey began are included in the filename. If the start date is missing, the current date is used. If necessary, the transect name is stripped of any characters that violate the filename conventions.

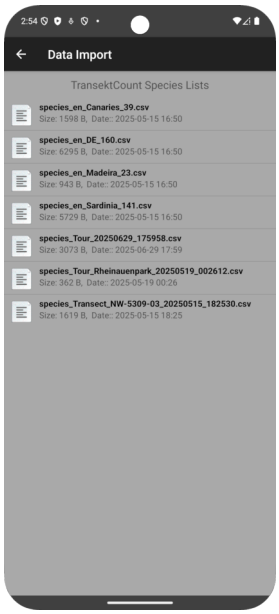


Fig. 14: Import File Selection

The function "**Import Species List**" (**Fig. 1**4) lets you select and import an available species list. The metadata is retained during import, but all counting data is deleted. If the **TourCount** app (see "**7.4 References**") is installed, the exported species lists can be imported mutually.

Starting with app **version 5.0.5**, the species list has been updated to include the data language. The available data languages are German, English, French, Italian, and Spanish. When local species names were available, they have been included for the species listed in the app. For imported species list files

created prior to this update, the correct data language should be selected via “Settings” to ensure proper processing.

Note: Importing a species list deletes all current counting data. The file name of a species list must always begin with “**species_**”, otherwise the list cannot be imported.

With “**Export Species List**” the current **species list** (without any other data) can be exported as a CSV file (CSV = Comma Separated Values text file) "**species_dl_Tr-No_CurrentDate.csv**”.
Here, too, the transect name is inserted if it exists in the metadata and, if necessary, cleaned up to remove characters that violate the filename conventions.
If a species list was imported that was exported from an app version earlier than 5.0.5, its data language can be set later under “**Settings**”, and the list can be exported again. After that, its data language will be automatically detected and set in the future.

"**Import GPS Track**" reads a prepared gpx Track file (e. g. transektcount_t1.gpx) from directory "**Documents/TransektCount**". In "**5. GPS Usage**" is shown how to create and handle a GPX file.

The functions “**Export Results (xlsx)**” and “**Export Results (csv)**” write the inspection metadata and the counting results into the formatted Excel spreadsheet file “**Transect_dl_Tr-No_StartDate_osc.xlsx**” respective into the structured, comma separated .csv textfile “**Transect_di_Tr-No_StartDate_osc.csv**” to the directory **Documents/TransektCount**. The file names will include the start date of the inspection, if available; otherwise, it will include the current date.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R
1	**Transect No.**	**Inspector Name**	**Date**		**Time**	**Temp. (°C)**	**Wind (0–4)**	**Clouds (%)**		**CW**		**Inspection Note**					Sorted by section + name	
2	NW-5309-03	Wilhelm Stein	2024-06-10	from:	16:40	22	1	10		24		Less individuals as meadows mowed						
3				to:	17:35	23	1	25										
4																		
5	**Section**		**Species**			**Internal**						**External**						
6	**Name**	**1. Count**	**Name**	**English name**	**Species Code**	**Butterfly ♂♀**	**Butterfly ♂**	**Butterfly ♀**	**Pupa**	**Larva**	**Egg**	**Butterfly ♂♀**	**Butterfly ♂**	**Butterfly ♀**	**Pupa**	**Larva**	**Egg**	**Species Notes**
7	Sect 01	16:47:01	Aricia agestis	Brown argus	07145	3						2						
8			Carteroce. palaemon	Chequered skipper	06919	1												First one ever
9			Colias hyale	Pale clouded yellow	07021	1	2	1				2						Photo f.
10			Leptidea sinapis/juvern.	Wood white	06966	1						2						
11			Pieris rapae	Small white	06998													0
12			Satyrium pruni	Black hairstreak	07063		1											Photo
13			Thymelicus sylvestris	Small skipper	06924	1												
14			Zygaena filipendulae	Six-spot burnet	03998	1						2						
15	Sect 02	16:58:01	Aglais urticae	Small tortoiseshell	07250	1												
16			Celastrina argiolus	Holly blue	07097	1												
17			Gonepteryx rhamni	Common brimstone	07024		1											Photo
18			Melanargia galathea	Marbled white	07415	1												Photo
19			Ochlodes sylvanus	Large skipper	06930	1	1											
20			Papilio machaon	Swallowtail	06960	1												In quick flight
21			Thecla betulae	Brown hairstreak	07047	1	1											
22	Sect 03	17:14:50	Aricia agestis	Brown argus	07145	1						1						
23			Gonepteryx rhamni	Common brimstone	07024		1					2						Photo
24			Maniola jurtina	Meadow brown	07350	1												
25			Ochlodes sylvanus	Large skipper	06930	1												
26			Pieris napi	Green-veined white	07000		2											
27			Thymelicus sylvestris	Small skipper	06924	1												Foto
28			Zygaena filipendulae	Six-spot burnet	03998	1												
29																		
30						**Internal**						**External**						
31			**Diff. Species**			**Butterfly ♂♀**	**Butterfly ♂**	**Butterfly ♀**	**Pupa**	**Larva**	**Egg**	**Butterfly ♂♀**	**Butterfly ♂**	**Butterfly ♀**	**Pupa**	**Larva**	**Egg**	**Totals**
32			**17**		**Totals (internal):**	19	9	1										29
33					**Totals (external):**							11						11
34					**Totals (all):**													40

Fig. 15: Exported XLSX table opened in LibreOffice Calc

Fig. 15 shows an Excel Results file in the LibreOffice Calc application.

To simplify data entry depending on the design of the input form of a central monitoring website, such as **https://web.app.ufz.de/tagfalter-monitoring/** the count data part of the table can be sorted beforehand using the “**Sorting the Results**” option in TransektCount’s settings. The output sorting options are: by species name, species code, as well as section + species name and section + species code.

The exported result files could be viewed and, to a limited extent, edited in a spreadsheet app such as **Collabora** (open source, free, based on LibreOffice). It is available in the F-Droid app store or in the Play Store

The exported .xlsx or .csv result files can also be transferred to a PC for further processing (see **7.1 Tips**). They may be loaded or imported into a spreadsheet program (tested with MS Excel, LibreOffice Calc, and Softmaker PlanMaker).

IT-affine users may transfer the exported database (**.db**) files from "Documents/TransektCount" to a PC. There you may examine or edit them manually or per SQL script with a free tool like "**DB Browser for SQLite**" (**https://sqlitebrowser.org**). Some useful example SQL scripts are published in the docs directory of the GitHub TransektCount project site **https://github.com/wistein/TransektCount/tree/master/docs**.

Under "**App Info**" you may find general app info, the email address of the author and the history.

Under "**Licenses**" you find the license notes for code and figures.

The option menu of the counting page provides a "**Photo**" function to quickly take a photo and a "**Share**" function for sending TransektCount related notes using a standard app, like SMS or email.

Optionally, the counter view is temporarily switched off by means of the **proximity sensor** when the phone is pocketed or closely held to the body. This saves energy, prevents unwanted input and recalls the app into its current state immediately when used again.

The app shows several short **pop-up messages** in 4 categories:

- **Error** (e.g. with a database problem)
- **Warning** (e.g. in the event of an invalid entry)
- **Note** (e.g. if an action might last longer)
- **Info** (e.g. after a successful process)

5. GPS Usage

Automatic section recognition in the transect is performed by comparing the current position with the track coordinates of the transect sections in a transektcount_xxx.gpx file. If the current position is no further than e.g. 5 m (default setting) away from a section track point, the section is indicated for registration. Contact between two transect sections should be avoided and gaps of approx. 5 m between sections are recommended. GPS inaccuracies may have to be accepted in some cases, but modern smartphones are now very accurate.

The preset deviation radius (**Max. Distance of track deviation**) can be set between 2 and 10 m (default: 5 m) to accommodate the device's GPS accuracy.

To strike a balance between performance and power consumption, you can set the **Min. distance for GPS update** between 0 and 5 m (default: 5 m) and the **GPS polling interval** between 1 and 10 seconds (default: 3 seconds).

5.1 Creating the Track File for TransektCount

A transect route can be recorded using a free smartphone app such as CoMaps or another hiking map app that can export the recorded track with sufficient accuracy in GPX format. It is advisable to record the transect route several times with the smartphone on-site. The recorded track should match the route shown on the map. Discrepancies between the map route and similar repeated recordings of the transect track suggest inaccuracies in the map.

In addition, named waypoints should be set at the section boundaries during recording. The recordings are intended to serve as a guide for the section tracks that will subsequently be drawn manually for a sufficient precision.

On Windows:
You may use the free **BaseCamp** program from Garmin. Load a suitable free map based on OpenStreetMap. Import the recorded transect GPX tracks.

When manually drawing track sections in BaseCamp, you should use the **highest possible zoom level**, as this allows you to achieve optimal spacing of approximately 2 meters between individual track points when drawing a track. This ensures sufficient accuracy for coordinate matching to identify sections within the app.

The transect sections must be drawn as new section tracks in the **same number and order** as they are listed in TransektCount. During import of the created .gpx file in TransektCount, they are assigned to the existing transect sections in this order. Naming them as shown in **Fig. 16** is intended solely for your own reference and is ignored by TransektCount.

Draw each section track with the individual **track points spaced approximately 2 meters apart** along the imaginary, averaged line of the recorded route. Leave a **gap of approximately 5 meters** between each section track.

Once all the section tracks are completely created, delete the transect GPX tracks that were previously imported from your smartphone.

The drawn transect tracks can then be exported to the file “**transektcount_xxx.gpx**”, where the prefix “**transektcount**” is significant and “**xxx**” serves as a placeholder for a transect name.

Fig. 16 shows a screenshot of BaseCamp with the section tracks of a transect example.

On Linux:
You can use the **Viking** program for this. Although its user interface differs significantly from BaseCamp, the result is just as useful. The procedure is the same as that described in “**On Windows**”.

In Viking, the result must be exported as a “**Single GPX File**”.

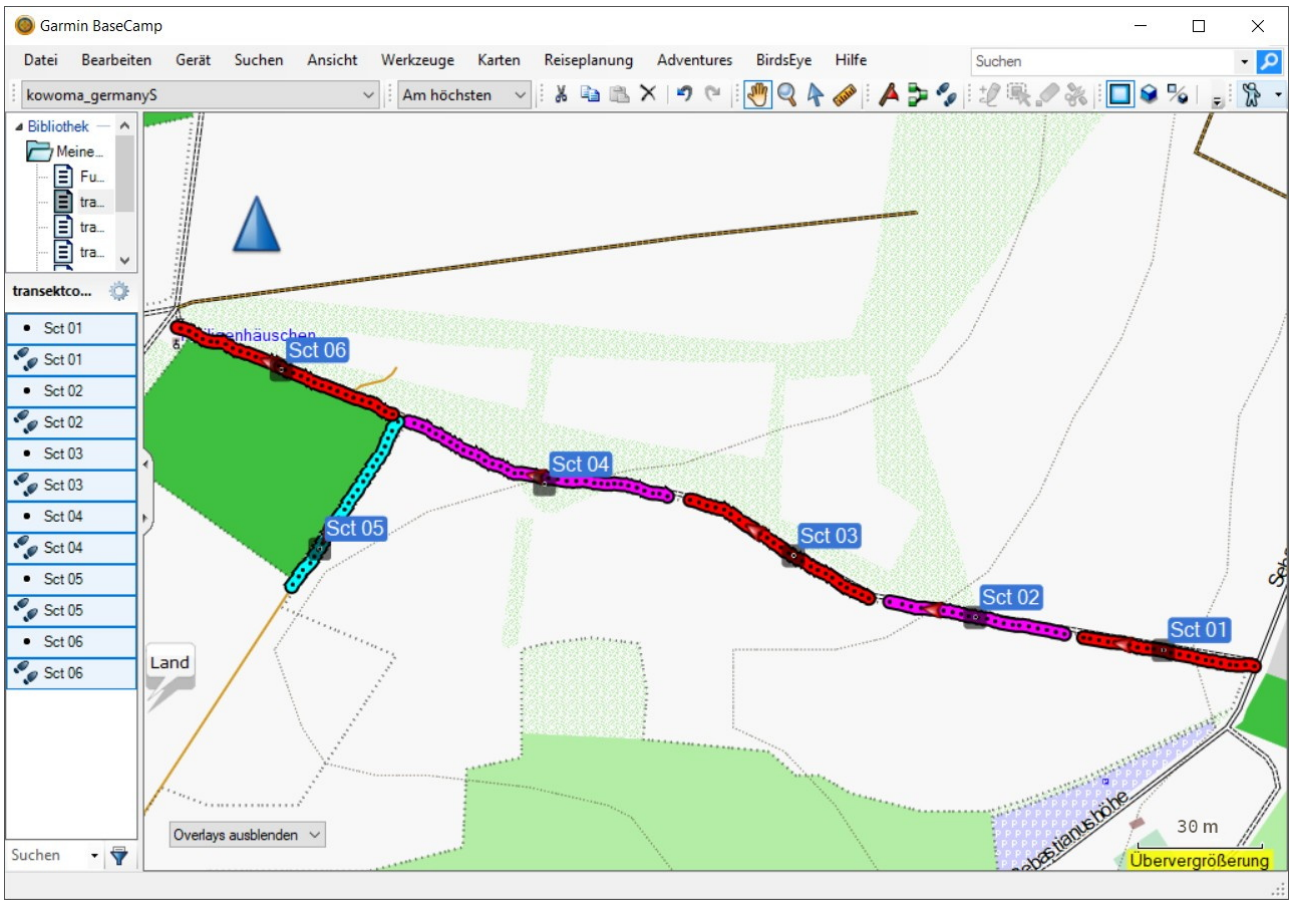


Fig. 16: Track creation in BaseCamp (Section labels and colours in the image are for explanatory purposes only)

5.2 Usage of the Track File in TransektCount

Copy the created .gpx track file “**transektcount_xxx.gpx**” to **"Documents/TransektCount"** on the smartphone. There it is expected by the app for import.

If the track file has been created correctly, the “**Import GPS Track**” command will acknowledge this with the message “**The GPX file has been imported.**”

Finally, activate the item **"Indicate transect section by GPS"** under Settings and, if necessary, adjust the sensitivity under **"Maximum GPS deviation allowed"**.

As the number of transect sections must be equal to the number of tracks, adding a new transect section is only possible as long as no tracks have been imported. Therefore, before adding a new transect section existing tracks must be deleted from the database using the **"Delete GPS Track Data"** function.

After adding a new section, the track file assigned to the transect must also be supplemented with the track of the new section in BaseCamp, Viking or a similar application and reimported into TransektCount.

When a transect section is deleted, the corresponding section track is also deleted from the database.

6. Installation Hints

6.1 Install the App From F-Droid Store (released versions, recommended)

Get TransektCount without docs or example Basic-DBs but with updates by the F-Droid app store:

App: **https://f-droid.org/en/packages/com.wmstein.transektcount**

Note on F-Droid:
Getting apps from F-Droid is at least as secure as getting them from the Google Play Store.
In contrast to the Google Play Store, all apps are also checked for data protection and compiled by F-Droid itself from the original source code. Advertising and tracking functions are not permitted. Restrictions and other potentially undesirable functions are explicitly indicated.

The source codes of the apps offered by F-Droid are generally published, linked, and licensed as open source.

6.2 Install the App From the Author's GitHub Project Pages (current development status)

App: **https://github.com/wistein/TransektCount/tree/master/apk**

Download the .apk file from the GitHub page into the Downloads directory.
Before installing, activate on the smartphone the Android option "Unknown source" in "Settings -> Security".
Then use the filemanager to install the app by clicking on the apk-file in the download folder.

Important: Finally, deactivate the option "Unknown source"!

6.3 Setting Up the App

After installation start the app once to create the necessary data directory **Documents/TransektCount**.
Then you may get the documentation and relevant species lists from the author's GitHub pages.

Docs: **https://github.com/wistein/TransektCount/tree/master/docs**

Copy these from the download folder into the new data directory **Documents/TransektCount**.
Now you can restart the app and finish setting it up.

Furthermore, the mentioned GitHub directory contains some example SQL scripts for editing the SQLite .db-files, if you like.

6.4 Notes on Updates

Unfortunately, the two installation methods mentioned above are not mutually compatible for updates, since although the .apk files are generated from identical source code, they are signed with different keys.

In the case of major version jumps with functional additions, structural changes may have been made in the internal database of the app. After such a change, the database version is incremented. This is recognized by the app and the currently used DB is adapted internally.

All sample DBs are published in the current version.
However, a DB file in its current version may not be backward compatible with previous app versions.

7. Annex

7.1 Tips

Transferring Data Between Smartphone and PC

Connect the smartphone to the PC using a USB cable. In the smartphone notifications find „**Charging this device via USB**“, tab for more options and select „**Use USB for file transfer**“.

In Windows Explorer or under Linux in Nautilus, Nemo or similar file manager the smartphone is now shown with its technical ID. In the "**Internal shared memory**" area, the "**Documents/TransektCount**" directory can be read and written to for data exchange.

7.2 Error Messages

When attempting to delete a section with a crossed-out delete symbol from the section list:

Section nn: To prevent DB corruption it is not possible to delete this section. Only the last created section may be deleted. (If the last created section cannot be deleted then your device has unfortunately not enough *free resources to execute the delete function.)*

Normally, the last transect section can be deleted (delete symbol is not crossed out). This effect occurs depending on the technical equipment of the device. With current models, however, this restriction should only occur with very many transect sections. Other functions of the app are not affected by this restriction.

Possible solutions:

1. Reverse the sorting of the section list under Settings and try again.

2. Reduce the DB by one section with "SqliteBrowser"
   Copy the exported DB to a PC and reduce it by one section using the "SqliteBrowser" tool.
   - Load the DB in SqliteBrowser.
   - Delete all entries with the highest "section_id" in the "counts" table.
   - Then note the name of the last entry in the "sections" table and delete the line.
   - Finally, in the "tracks" table, delete all rows with this name in the "tsection" column.
   - Save the changes.

   Copy the modified DB back to the Android device. Repeat the process if necessary.

3. Reduce the DB by one section with second Android device with more RAM
   Either connect the two devices directly via USB or WLAN or connect both to a PC and copy the DB from there to the "Documents/TransektCount" directory of the other device.
   - Import into TransektCount there,
   - delete the last section,
   - export the DB and copy it back.
   - Repeat the process if necessary.

4. Set up the DB again
   - Create the species list in section 1 and fill it with the desired species.
   - Duplicate section and name new section accordingly.
   - Export DB.
   - Check the section list to see whether the last section can be deleted.
   - If yes, create another section by duplicating, test and export if ok.
   - If not, the DB can use a maximum of one section less.
   - Repeat until the maximum number of sections is reached.

5. Use the DB with this flaw. There are no other known functional limitations.

7.3 Glossary

Counting range:
The counting range area corresponds to a cube of 5 m edge length in front of the observation point within a transect section. Individuals sighted are recorded separately inside and outside this imaginary cube.
Due to its Germany-wide standardization (also applies to various European countries), recording in the internal counting range is decisive for comparative evaluations.

CSV file:
Comma-separated values file. Text-based file format for exchanging data in tabular form (e.g. for importing TransektCount result data into spreadsheet programs).

F-Droid:
F-Droid is a repository of Free and Open Source Software (FOSS) applications Android.
The F-Droid client makes it easy to browse, install, and keep track of updates on your device.

File directories of TransektCount:
The public app-specific files directory (for DB files and exported CSV files) is:

"Documents/TransektCount"

Data stored here can also be read by other apps. The data is not automatically deleted when the app is uninstalled.

The previous app-specific directory for the DB files:

"Android/data/com.wmstein.transektcount/files/"

is no longer used from TransektCount version 4.0.0 on, as data stored here cannot be read by other apps in newer Android versions and was deleted when the app got uninstalled.

GitHub:
Is a file hosting site for software development projects including version control. It is free of charge for Open Source Projects. It was named after the version control and source code management system Git. Run by GitHub, Inc. from San Francisco, USA. Since December 2018 the company belongs to Microsoft. According to Microsoft GitHub will remain an independent platform.

Numbering scheme according to Karsholt/Razowski:
The entomologists O. Karsholt and J. Razowski developed a numbering scheme for European butterfly species, which is used in the German Lepiforum and elsewhere. According to this numbering scheme, codes are used in TransektCount to identify the species. However, this restricts the use of TransektCount to European faunal areas, as there is no comparable scheme that is valid worldwide.

Open Source:
Source code of software, which can be edited and used publicly. Open Source software can mostly be used free of charge and does not contain propriately licensed or closed source elements.

Transect:
A predetermined route along which someone counts and notes the occurrence of certain species. This route is divided into sections of approx. 50 m in length that are as homogeneous as possible in terms of vegetation. In particular, the individuals within a defined → **counting range** are counted.

7.4 References

TransektCount

TransektCount project:
The repository of the TransektCount project is situated on **https://github.com/wistein/TransektCount**.
It contains all published files with source code, configuration of the Android Studio Development platform, documentation and installable APK files.

TransektCount Documents:
You find documents, example databases, SQL scripts for manipulating TransektCount DBs and other information under **https://github.com/wistein/TransektCount/tree/master/docs**.

TransektCount-App:
The released version can be installed from
https://f-droid.org/en/packages/com.wmstein.transektcount/.

TourCount

TourCount is the complementary Android app to support you when recording butterflies in nature.
It allows to register individuals species-specific, separated by gender and metamorphic stages as well as individually localized in the field by GPS.

TourCount project:
The repository of the TourCount project is situated on **https://github.com/wistein/TourCount**.
It contains all published files with source code, configuration of the Android Studio Development platform, documentation and installable APK files.

TourCount Documents:
You find documents, example databases, SQL scripts for manipulating TourCount DBs and other information under **https://github.com/wistein/TourCount/tree/master/docs**.

TourCount-App:
The released version can be installed from
https://f-droid.org/en/packages/com.wmstein.tourcount/.